

Invisible waves

Radio waves are invisible waves of energy. The height, width, and pattern of the waves tell the helicopter to change direction or speed.

In a spin

The helicopter's rotor blades tilt when the toy receives a signal to change its direction of flight.

Not too far!

The radio waves get weaker the farther away they are from the transmitter. If the helicopter strays too far, the transmitter will lose control of it.

Receiving signals

An antenna inside the helicopter receives the signal from the transmitter.

Remote control in space

The two Voyager spacecraft were sent into space in 1977 to take photographs of planets and moons in our solar system. Even though they are now 12 billion miles (20 billion km) away, they are still controlled from our planet. The Voyagers receive the faint radio signals using sensitive receivers pointed directly at transmitters on the Earth.

